

Dacelo novaeguineae

Laughing kookaburra



Length 416½ in (42 cm)
Weight 13 oz (350 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location E., S.E., and S.W. Australia (including Tasmania), New Zealand



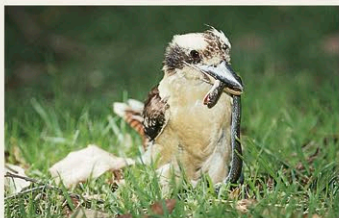
The largest of all kingfishers, the laughing kookaburra is known throughout Australia for its raucous call, which it delivers with partly opened bill pointing skyward and its tail cocked. In urban areas, it becomes quite tame and may even be fed by hand. It is found in strong family groups, which during the day keep within sight or sound of each other, and at night, roost together. This bird has been introduced in southwest Australia, Tasmania, and New Zealand.



EYE-STRIPES

The kookaburra's back and wings are dark brown, while its underparts are a dusky white. Its white head has a distinctive black eye-stripe.

FEEDING



Unlike river kingfishers, this kookaburra captures prey on the ground. It sits on an exposed perch waiting for likely victims—such as insects, snails, frogs, small birds, fish, and reptiles—and then swoops down on them. It crushes small prey in its bill; larger prey, like the snake the bird pictured above has caught, are beaten to death against a branch.

Coracias garrulus

European roller



Length 12½ in (32 cm)
Weight 5 oz (150 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Migrant
Status Least concern

Location Africa, Europe, W. and C. Asia



The European roller is a heavy-bodied bird with conspicuous, blue and tobacco-coloured plumage and black wing-tips. It spends long periods sitting on a prominent perch, such as a bare branch or a power line, looking for

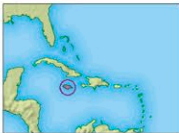
prey on the ground. It feeds mainly on insects, but also eats small reptiles, mammals, birds, and fruit. The nest is built in a hollow limb or hole in a tree.



blue underparts

Todus todus

Jamaican tody



Length 4¼ in (11 cm)
Weight 7½ oz (6 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location Jamaica



The Jamaican tody is one of 5 species of small, vivid green, kingfisherlike birds with a large head, a long, flat, bicolored bill, and a prominent crimson bib. It perches on small branches with its bill upturned, looking for insects on the undersides of overhanging leaves and

twigs. It usually darts out rapidly to snatch prey, but will sometimes hover. Extremely active from dawn to dusk, it has one of the highest feeding rates known in birds. Its call consists of a loud, nasal "beep".



Momotus momota

Amazonian motmot



Length 18½ in (47 cm)
Weight 5 oz (150 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location Central America to C. South America, Trinidad and Tobago



The Amazonian motmot is a robust bird with elongated central tail feathers that are bare except for the tips. Its plumage is generally green and it has a black eye-stripe. For most of the day, this quiet, unobtrusive bird sits on a low branch, intermittently swinging its racquet-tipped tail like a pendulum. However, it is very active in the early morning and evening, emitting a far-carrying "hoot-hoot" call. The Amazonian motmot feeds mainly on insects, either



capturing prey on the ground or probing into leaf litter; it also snatches prey from tree trunks.

Merops apiaster

European bee-eater



Length 12 in (30 cm)
Weight 2½ oz (70 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Migrant
Status Least concern

Location Africa, Europe, W., C., and S. Asia



One of the most aerial of all bee-eaters, this medium-sized bird has long wings and a sharply pointed bill. During the day, it perches on telegraph wires, fences, or branches. It preys on stinging insects, which it de-venoms by rubbing the insect's tail-end rapidly against the perch and squeezing it in its bill to expel the venom and sting. It breeds in colonies and nests in burrows.



yellow throat

dark eye-stripe

bluish green tail

Merops bullockoides

White-fronted bee-eater



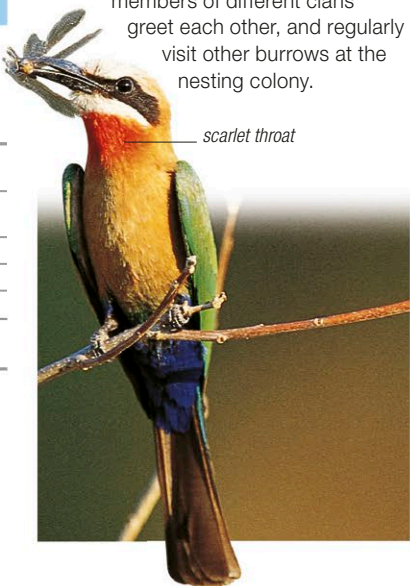
Length 9 in (23 cm)
Weight 1¼ oz (35 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa



The white-fronted bee-eater lives in a social unit, known as a clan, of up to 16 individuals. These clans associate in nesting colonies of 500 or more birds. Although each clan vigorously defends its own foraging territory,

members of different clans greet each other, and regularly visit other burrows at the nesting colony.



scarlet throat